

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

INDIA – EU – 01

MODULE – 48

BACKGROUND OF EU

- 1 The Second World War shattered many of the assumptions and structures on which the European states had based their relations.
- 2 In 1945, the economies of the European states was ruined as the World Wars was fought on these lands
- 3 There was an urgent need to rebuild the economies after destruction caused by the wars.
- 4 United States supported the reconstruction of Europe through the 'Marshall Plan'. to counterbalance the communist Soviet Union
- 5 The US also created a new collective security structure under North Atlantic Treaty Organisation (NATO).



EVOLUTION OF EU

- 1 In 1951, France, Germany, Italy, Belgium, Netherlands and Luxembourg signed the Treaty of Paris and formed the European Coal and Steel Community (ECSC).
- 2 This process acquired a political dimension with the creation of the European Parliament.
- 3 With the Maastricht Treaty of 1992, the European Union (EU) came into existence.
- 4 The members decided to formulate common foreign and defence policies. The foundation was thus laid for a common foreign and security policy, cooperation on justice and home affairs, and the creation of a single currency.



EVOLUTION OF EU

- 5 The European Union has evolved over time from an economic union to an increasingly political one.
- 6 While the attempts to have a Constitution for the EU have failed, it has its own flag, anthem, founding date, and currency.
- 7 It also has some form of a common foreign and security policy in its dealings with other nations.
- 8 In 1999, the Eurozone was created, and Euro was decided to be the currency of the Eurozone members.
- 9 The Treaty of Lisbon of 2009 was an attempt to give EU its first Constitution.
- 10 The European Union has tried to expand areas of cooperation while acquiring new members, especially from the erstwhile Soviet bloc.



EVOLUTION OF EU

- 11** New objectives of trade, security, energy and global warming were included in the Treaty.
- 12** Currently 27 countries are member states of EU.
- 13** Every member state is part of the founding treaties of the union and is subjected to binding laws within the common legislative and judicial institutions.
- 14** In order for the EU to adopt policies that concern defence and foreign affairs, all member states must agree unanimously.



OBJECTIVES OF EUROPEAN UNION

- 1 Promote closer economic and political integration of member countries.
- 2 Establishment of an Economic and Monetary Union.
- 3 Common economic and defence policy of member countries.
- 4 Strengthening domestic economic and political institutions.
- 5 Developing relations among member countries in the sphere of home affairs and justice.



FEATURES OF EU

- 1 The members of European Union are committed to peace, democracy, rule of law and respect for human rights.
- 2 The single market of EU allows free movement of people, goods, services and capital.
- 3 Within the Schengen Area of European Union, the passport controls for travel are abolished.

- 4 The EU has economic, political and diplomatic, and military influence.



FEATURES OF EU

5 The EU is the world's second biggest economy with a GDP of more than \$18.8 trillion in 2018 representing 22 percent of the global economy.

6 Two members of the EU, Britain and France, hold permanent seats on the UN Security Council.

7 The EU includes several non-permanent members of the UNSC.

8 Militarily, the EU's combined armed forces are the second largest in the world.

9 Its total spending on defence is second after the US.



ORGANISATIONS OF EUROPEAN UNION

1 THE COUNCIL-

- Informally called the Council of Ministers, the Council is the decision-making body of the European Union.
- It has 27 member states. The member states are accountable to their own assemblies.
- The Presidency of the Union rotates every six months and decisions are taken unanimously.



2 EUROPEAN COUNCIL-

- Informally known as the European summit, The European Council comprises the Presidents and Prime Ministers of the member countries.
- The European Council provides strategic leadership to the union. They meet four times a year.



ORGANISATIONS OF EUROPEAN UNION

3 EUROPEAN COMMISSION-

- It is the **bureaucratic arm** of the European Union.
- The Commission is based in Brussels. It **proposes legislation** and is a **watchdog** to ensure compliance of EU treaties.

4 EUROPEAN PARLIAMENT-

- It is **located in Strasbourg**. It has **751 members** who are **directly elected** for a period.
- All laws of the European Parliament are binding upon its members

5 EUROPEAN COURT OF JUSTICE-

- The ECJ is located in Luxembourg.
- It **interprets and adjudicates** upon the **laws passed** in the European Union



CHALLENGES FACED BY EUROPEAN UNION

- The main challenges faced by European Union are political and economic:

- The fiscal situation in Portugal, Italy, Greece and Spain (PIGS countries) challenge economic integration of European Union.
➤ Germany tried to bring fiscal discipline and bailed out its fellow EU members.

- 2 In many areas its member states have their own foreign relations and defence policies that are often at odds with each other.

- 3 Cheap labour from Eastern European countries have caused job losses in developed parts.

- 4 Migration from Middle East have caused law and order problems, refugee problem and rise of terrorism in developed parts in developed parts of Europe.



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